NETWORK ASSESSMENT PROPOSAL AND PRELIMINARY FINDINGS

Aranda environment | CEO review draft

Prepared from the supplied topology diagram and exported non-Meraki switch configurations.
This is a preliminary executive assessment. Final sign-off requires Meraki MS dashboard/API validation because the Meraki switch set was not included in the exported text configs.

Prepared for	Executive / CEO review
Assessment status	Preliminary - missing Meraki MS core/aggregation review

Prepared in MSP executive-report format
April 2026

Executive Summary

Bottom line

The supplied network appears functional and segmented, but it is not yet operating at a fully standardized MSP or enterprise support standard. The highest-risk issue identified in the supplied evidence is the presence of private cryptographic material and privileged local management information inside exported switch backups. In parallel, the missing Meraki MS switch set creates a major blind spot because the provided topology suggests the omitted Meraki equipment likely includes part of the aggregation/core switching layer.

Overall condition	Functional, but operationally inconsistent and incomplete for final sign-off
Overall risk	Moderate to High (elevated to High for security hygiene)
Most urgent issue	Rotate exposed admin credentials / SSH keys / certificates and tighten config backup handling
Most important missing evidence	Meraki MS dashboard/API data for switch settings, ports, LAGs, ACLs, policies, DHCP/DAI, and any Layer 3 interfaces
Immediate business concern	Avoidable outage and security exposure caused by incomplete documentation, mixed management design, and shared/exported sensitive material

What we reviewed

Inputs reviewed included: the provided topology diagram, four Cisco Small Business/Aranda text configurations, and six Netgear Smart/Plus switch export files.

- Text configuration files reviewed: arandaswitch01, arandaswitch02, arandaswitch03, arandaswitch04.
- Netgear Smart/Plus exports reviewed: ArandaNetgear11, 14, 15, and ArandaNetgear2, 3, 4.
- The Meraki MX/MS environment was not fully assessable from exported text alone; Meraki MS review remains outstanding.
- The supplied topology aligns directly with switch IPs 10.28.1.10 and 10.28.1.20, strongly suggesting those correspond to Office Switch-1 and Office Switch-2 in the diagram.

Executive observations

- Positive: VLAN-based segmentation is already present across office, guest, services, IoT, printers, and OT segments.
- Concern: management addressing and default gateways are inconsistent across the non-Meraki switch set, indicating an organically grown design rather than a standardized lifecycle-managed platform.

- Concern: one or more exported configs contain full private keys and certificates, which should be treated as a material security finding.
- Concern: the omitted Meraki MS switches appear likely to include core/aggregation switching functions, so the current assessment is necessarily preliminary.
- Concern: the environment contains a mixed vendor stack, including small-business/Plus-class switching, which increases support complexity and reduces operational consistency.

1. Client-Facing Proposal for a Formal Network Assessment

Below is a client-ready proposal structure that can be sent as the scope statement for the full network assessment engagement.

Proposed assessment objective

Provide a defensible, executive-ready review of the client's switching, segmentation, management plane, security posture, and operational resilience; validate how the Meraki MX/MS environment and non-Meraki switching estate work together; and deliver a prioritized remediation roadmap.

Phase	Activities	Client inputs	Outputs	Target duration
1. Discovery and evidence review	Review diagrams, exported configs, switch inventory, addressing, VLAN design, admin methods, and obvious security/operational gaps.	Topology, exported configs, switch inventory, read-only Meraki dashboard access.	Preliminary findings memo and evidence gap list.	1-2 business days
2. Meraki validation and live config capture	Validate Meraki MS switch settings, ports, LAGs, ACLs, access policies, DHCP/DAI policy, and any Layer 3 interfaces via Dashboard/API.	Read-only dashboard access or read-only API key.	Validated current-state config matrix and corrected topology.	1-2 business days
3. Risk ranking and remediation roadmap	Rank issues by business risk, outage risk, and cyber exposure; define quick wins, 30-day stabilization items, and strategic upgrades.	Optional stakeholder workshop for business priorities.	Executive summary, technical findings, and remediation roadmap.	1-2 business days

Recommended scope language

The assessment will evaluate switching architecture, VLAN and trunk design, management-plane design, Meraki MS and MX integration points, access control and privileged account exposure,

backup and configuration handling, operational standards (time, logging, monitoring, naming, firmware consistency), and supportability of the mixed-vendor switching estate. The assessment will conclude with an executive summary, a technical findings register, and a prioritized remediation roadmap.

Deliverables to promise the client

- Executive summary for leadership.
- Detailed technical findings register with risk ranking.
- Validated network topology and device inventory.
- 30-day stabilization plan and 90-day modernization roadmap.
- Meraki/MSP runbook requirements for backup handling, change control, and config recovery.
- Clear statement of what was verified directly versus what remains inferred until live validation is completed.

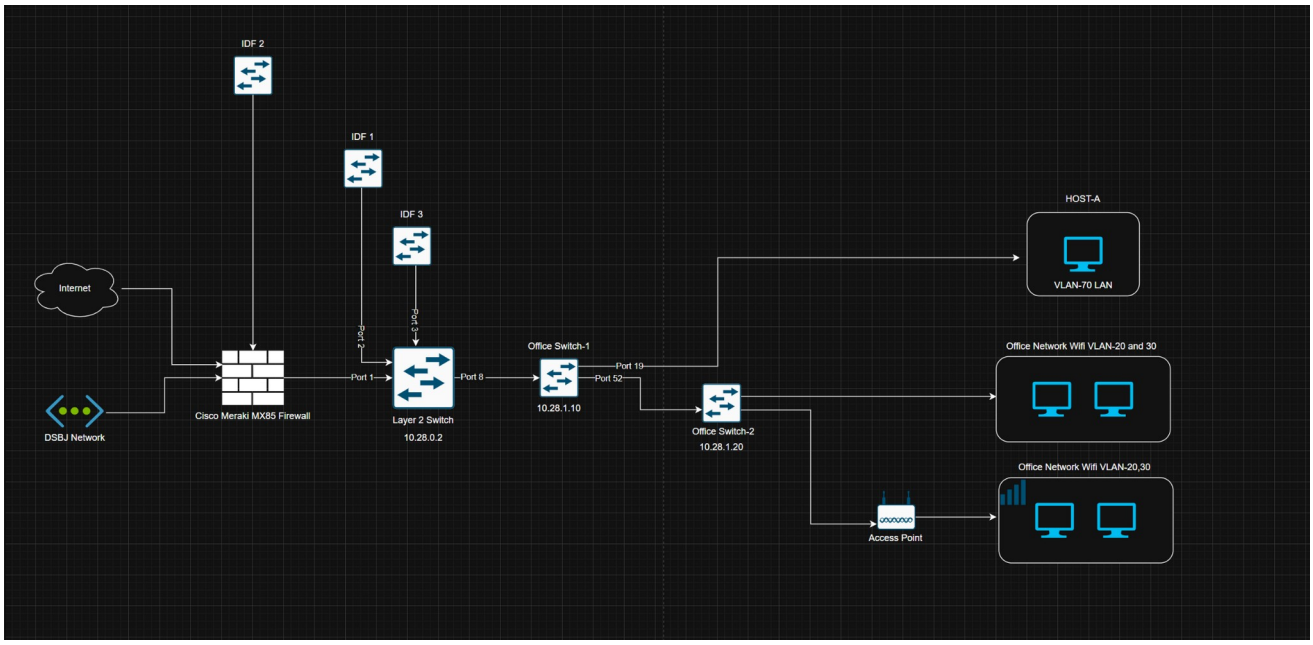
Proposed assumptions / exclusions

- This preliminary stage is document-based and does not replace live validation of physical links, spanning-tree state, client impact, or end-to-end service testing.
- Wireless, firewall policy, ISP circuits, and client endpoint health are only in scope to the extent they intersect with switch design and segmentation.
- Any findings tied to omitted Meraki MS switches remain preliminary until Dashboard/API review is complete.

2. Preliminary Assessment Based on the Supplied Files

This section reflects what can be responsibly concluded from the supplied evidence. It is useful and actionable today, but it is not the final answer until the Meraki MS switch layer is validated.

Current-state architecture inferred from the evidence



Provided topology diagram reviewed during the assessment.

Based on the diagram and the matching management IPs in the text exports, arandaswitch01 (10.28.1.10) and arandaswitch02 (10.28.1.20) align with Office Switch-1 and Office Switch-2. The central switch in the diagram is labeled 10.28.0.2 and does not appear in the supplied non-Meraki text configs, which increases the likelihood that at least part of the omitted Meraki MS set sits at the aggregation/core layer.

Preliminary device inventory recovered from the exports

Device	Recovered identity / management	Role inferred	Assessment note
arandaswitch01	10.10.0.10 on VLAN1; 10.28.1.10 on VLAN100; 172.28.5.5 on VLAN30; 172.28.12.5 on VLAN70	Primary office switch / distribution edge	Most complete non-Meraki config; multiple trunks; likely Office Switch-1.
arandaswitch02	10.10.0.20 on VLAN1; 10.28.1.20 on VLAN100	Downstream office switch	Matches Office Switch-2 IP in topology; mostly trunk uplinks plus limited access ports.
arandaswitch03	10.10.0.30 on VLAN1; 10.28.1.30 on VLAN100	Lightly configured edge / small IDF switch	Very limited port config; likely

			downstream access switch.
arandaswitch04	10.10.0.40 on VLAN1	Unknown / spare / legacy / incomplete export	Minimal switching config present; requires validation whether it is in production.
ArandaNetgear11	10.10.0.211 /16, gateway 10.10.0.1	Netgear Plus / edge device	Binary export; identity and management data recovered, but not a full-text running configuration.
ArandaNetgear14	10.10.0.214 /16, gateway 10.10.0.1	Netgear Smart switch	Default VLAN-centric configuration; limited explicit segmentation seen in export.
ArandaNetgear15	10.10.0.215 /16, gateway 10.10.0.1	Netgear Smart switch	VLAN 20 and VLAN 30 defined; one visible access/untagged port on g8.
ArandaNetgear2/3/4	10.10.0.202 / .203 / .204, gateway 10.10.0.1	Netgear Plus / edge devices	Binary exports partially decoded; suitable for inventory, not full configuration assurance.

Risk-ranked findings

Finding	Risk	Why it matters	Recommended action
Sensitive private keys and certificates are embedded in exported switch configs.	Critical	If those config backups were emailed, shared broadly, or stored insecurely, management trust should be treated as exposed. This is a direct cyber-risk issue, not just a documentation issue.	Rotate switch admin credentials, SSH keys, and local certificates immediately; restrict access to all historical backups; adopt secure configuration backup handling.

Privileged local account model is not standardized.	High	Different switches show multiple local admin usernames and inconsistent naming conventions. This increases support risk and makes offboarding, accountability, and incident response harder.	Standardize named-admin access, remove unnecessary local accounts, and align on a privileged access policy.
Meraki MS switch layer is missing from the exported evidence.	High	The omitted Meraki MS equipment likely includes at least part of the aggregation/core design, so the current assessment cannot fully validate uplinks, STP, LAG, ACL, or Layer 3 behavior.	Obtain Meraki dashboard/API configuration snapshot and complete a second-pass review before declaring the network fully assessed.
Management plane is inconsistent across the non-Meraki switching estate.	High	Management addressing spans 10.10.0.0/16 and 10.28.x.x, with different default gateways and multiple management-capable SVIs on Layer 2 switches. This creates ambiguity for monitoring, support, and recovery.	Choose one management design standard, then normalize switch IPs, gateways, VLAN placement, and naming.
Segmentation exists, but standards and enforcement consistency are unclear.	Moderate	The VLAN model is directionally good, but the absence of the Meraki core layer and the mixed vendor set means the true end-to-end enforcement model is not fully verified.	Validate VLAN carriage and gatewaying across Meraki MS, office switches, AP uplinks, and printer/IoT segments.
Several ports use non-standard or ambiguous	Moderate	Ports that mix trunk mode with	Review every trunk/uplink against

trunk/native VLAN combinations.		access/native VLAN settings can be valid, but they deserve live intent validation because they are common sources of outage during moves/adds/changes.	the physical topology and confirm allowed/native VLAN intent.
Operational standards are not yet normalized.	Moderate	Time/NTP settings and general configuration consistency differ across devices. That weakens troubleshooting, logging quality, and post-incident analysis.	Standardize NTP, timezone, logging, naming, and firmware/lifecycle management.
Mixed small-business / Plus-class switching increases support overhead.	Moderate	A mixed platform environment usually increases tool fragmentation, recovery complexity, and configuration drift.	Decide whether the Netgear edge switches remain acceptable, should be isolated to low-risk roles, or should be folded into a standardized switching platform.

Positive findings worth preserving

- The environment already shows meaningful VLAN segmentation instead of a single flat network.
- The provided topology is useful and aligns with at least part of the recovered switch addressing, which is a better starting point than many SMB assessments.
- The office, guest, printer, IoT, and OT concepts are already separated at least at the logical-design level.
- The switch estate appears recoverable and documentable; this is not a redesign-from-scratch situation, but it does need standardization.

3. Recommended Remediation Roadmap

Immediate actions: first 72 hours

- Treat the exported switch backups as sensitive incident material because multiple files include private keys and privileged management details.
- Rotate local switch admin credentials where appropriate, especially on devices whose backups were distributed externally or stored outside a secured vault.
- Regenerate or replace exposed SSH keys and locally installed certificates on affected switches.
- Restrict access to all existing configuration archives and confirm who received the files.
- Confirm whether arandaswitch04 and the Netgear Plus devices are still in production, and remove/retire anything no longer needed.

Stabilization actions: 30 days

- Normalize the management network standard: addressing, VLAN, gateway, NTP, logging, SNMP/monitoring, naming, and backup method.
- Build a definitive port map for every uplink, AP connection, printer segment, and IDF handoff.
- Validate all trunk/native VLAN definitions on Office Switch-1, Office Switch-2, and the missing Meraki MS aggregation layer.
- Review whether all local admin accounts are still required and align on named administrative access.
- Establish secure backup handling and change control for both Meraki and non-Meraki devices.

Strategic actions: 90 days

- Decide on the long-term switching standard and whether the Netgear Plus/Smart devices remain acceptable in production.
- Consider consolidating management and operational monitoring into a single documented MSP support model.
- Review segmentation policy end-to-end for office, guest, wireless, IoT, printers, and OT.
- Update the topology into a maintained source-of-truth document that includes switch names, models, serials, management IPs, uplinks, LAGs, and VLAN intent.
- Perform a post-remediation validation assessment after the Meraki MS layer is documented and standardized.

CEO-level takeaway

Why leadership should care

This environment does not show signs of immediate structural collapse, but it does show the classic symptoms of a network that grew faster than its operating standard. The risk is not only cyber-risk; it is also avoidable outage risk, avoidable recovery delay, and avoidable dependency on tribal knowledge. The network can be stabilized without a wholesale rebuild, but the Meraki core layer and credential hygiene need prompt attention.

4. Meraki MS Configuration Request and Extraction Guidance

Important note for the client

Meraki MS switches do not provide the same kind of traditional, readable running-config text file that you would expect from a classic CLI-managed switch. For assessment purposes, the correct source of truth is the Meraki Dashboard and/or a structured Dashboard API export.

What we need from the Meraki MS environment

- Switch inventory: switch name, model, serial, network, and management IP details.
- Global switch settings: management VLAN, STP/RSTP, QoS, multicast, MTU, storm control, and any uplink client-sampling changes.
- All switch ports for each MS device: mode, VLAN, native VLAN, allowed VLANs, port name, STP settings, PoE, schedules, tags, and access policy assignment.
- Any link aggregation groups / port channels.
- Any MS Layer 3 interfaces, default-gateway behavior, or routed uplinks if Layer 3 switching is in use.
- Any switch ACLs, switch access policies, and DHCP / ARP-inspection related settings.
- Configuration change history for recent switch changes, if available.

Preferred extraction method: Dashboard API snapshot

1. An organization administrator generates a read-only Meraki API key.
2. Use the API key with the Meraki Dashboard API to export the switch network data for the relevant organization/network(s).
3. Capture the following datasets at minimum: organization device inventory, network switch settings, device switch ports, device switch Layer 3 interfaces (if any), switch ACLs, switch access policies, DHCP server policy, and link aggregations.
4. Package the results as JSON or CSV plus a simple inventory sheet, then attach that to the assessment evidence package.

Meraki data item	Useful API operation(s)
Inventory of assigned devices	getOrganizationDevices / getOrganizationInventoryDevices
Global switch settings	getNetworkSwitchSettings
Per-switch port configuration	getDeviceSwitchPorts
MS Layer 3 interfaces	getDeviceSwitchRoutingInterfaces
Switch ACLs	getNetworkSwitchAccessControlLists
Switch access policies	getNetworkSwitchAccessPolicies
DHCP / DAI policy	getNetworkSwitchDhcpServerPolicy

Link aggregation groups	getNetworkSwitchLinkAggregations

Fallback method: Dashboard screenshots / live read-only review

5. Review the Meraki switch inventory page and record every MS device in scope.
6. Review the Switch Settings page for management VLAN, spanning tree, QoS, multicast, MTU, and storm-control related settings.
7. Review the Switch Ports page and each critical uplink/device page for port mode, VLANs, native VLAN, allowed VLANs, access policy, PoE, and STP settings.
8. Capture any Layer 3 interface pages, ACL pages, access policy pages, DHCP-server-policy pages, and link aggregation pages that are in use.
9. Provide screenshots or exports for the uplinks tied to the MX, APs, office switches, IDFs, and any OT/printer/IoT segments.

Client-facing request language you can send

To complete the final network assessment, we also need the Meraki MS switch configuration source of truth. Because Meraki MS is cloud-managed, this is not a traditional text "running-config" export. Please provide either read-only dashboard access or a read-only Dashboard API export covering switch inventory, switch settings, all MS port configurations, link aggregations, switch ACLs, switch access policies, DHCP/DAI policy, and any MS Layer 3 interfaces. Without that data, the current report remains a preliminary assessment rather than a final validated network assessment.

Appendix: Evidence-Based Technical Notes

Recovered VLAN model from the non-Meraki text exports

VLAN	Observed label	Assessment note
10	Office Management VLAN	Defined on arandaswitch01 and arandaswitch02.
20	Office Wired / Office Computer VLAN	Primary user access VLAN across most reviewed access ports.
30	Office Wireless VLAN	Present in both the office switching model and Netgear15 export.
40	Office Wi-Fi Guest	Defined in switch database; end-to-end validation still needed.
50	Office Services	Defined but not fully validated from supplied data.
60	Office IoT	Defined but not fully validated from supplied data.
70	Office Printers VLAN	Present on arandaswitch01 and shown in the supplied topology.
100	OT Management VLAN	Management SVI observed on multiple Aranda switches.
110	OT Computers VLAN	Defined in core/office switch configs.
120	OT Printers VLAN	Defined in core/office switch configs.

Technical observations from the supplied non-Meraki text exports

- arandaswitch01 and arandaswitch02 operate with 'no ip routing', indicating Layer 2 switching plus management SVIs rather than local Layer 3 gatewaying.
- arandaswitch01 carries the widest VLAN/SVI set and is the clearest non-Meraki distribution/access anchor in the evidence provided.
- arandaswitch01 explicitly prefers spanning-tree priority 4096, suggesting it may have been intended to act as root within at least part of the reviewed non-Meraki domain.
- arandaswitch03 and arandaswitch04 use 10.10.0.1 as default gateway, while arandaswitch01 and arandaswitch02 use 10.28.0.1; this inconsistency warrants normalization.

- The Netgear Plus/Smart devices live in the 10.10.0.0/16 management space, which further supports the conclusion that management architecture has evolved over time rather than being standardized end-to-end.

Assessment limitations

- No live dashboard/API validation was performed against the Meraki MS estate from the supplied evidence package.
- Binary Netgear Plus exports are not equivalent to full-text running configs; they are useful for inventory and management details but not a complete control-plane audit.
- This report does not validate live client impact, wireless behavior, internet egress, STP state, or actual link utilization.
- Any production recommendations should be finalized only after the Meraki MS layer is reviewed and the port map is validated against the physical network.